
Application: Hiring Diligence Partner

Submitted to Fivetran for a role no recruiter is paid to do — pre-offer diligence and post-hire validation on the Vice President, Systems Engineering search. One page, £2,000 pilot, free Week-1 audit.

The role you didn't post a partner for. Vice President, Systems Engineering at Fivetran is a hire that compounds the next eighteen months or costs you them. The posting opened 18 days ago based in Oakland, California, United States, AMER. The recruiter on it is paid to close — their commercial interest ends at the signed offer. No one on the engagement is paid to surface why this candidate might be the wrong shape for the role, or to track whether they actually compound the team once they land. That gap is what this application is for.

The math. A search firm places the candidate. Spine evaluates whether they will work. On a £200k base, recruiter fees run **£50–66k**. Mis-hire cost — replacement, twelve months of lost output, opportunity cost — typically lands at **£500k to £2M**; a recent case Spine documented closed at **\$5.5M**. Spine's pilot is **£2,000**. Less than 5% of the search fee. Less than 0.5% of the downside that fee does not cover.

Week 1, free — Hire Risk Audit. A retrospective audit on a recent senior hire of Fivetran's, delivered as a one-page memo within five working days. Risk concentration in hindsight, scorecard, blind-spot map. No commercial commitment until Fivetran accepts the deliverable. The audit doesn't land — Fivetran keeps the memo and walks away. The audit lands — the pilot kicks in for the live Vice President, Systems Engineering search.

Week 2 → Day 90, £2,000 — full pilot. Pre-hire memo and scorecard before the offer is extended (risk concentration, blind spots, A-Player Probability range for this stage and role shape). Structured 60-day check-in tracking decision velocity, time to first verifiable outcome, and expectation drift. Day-90 binary recommendation — keep, expand, intervene, or replace. No placement fee. No recurring obligation. No procurement.

Three slots open. Spine is taking three pilot engagements through end of June 2026, filled in order received. Reply with the recent hire Fivetran would want audited and the Week-1 deliverable returns within five working days.